Interview Summary: dev_001

- 6-10 years of experience
- Private company
- Domain of developed software: Healthcare; Public Administration / Government; Transportation / Mobility; Industrial / Manufacturing; Research / Scientific Software
- Front-end development; Back-end development; Data / Database development; DevOps / Infrastructure / Cloud
- 2-5 developers per team

Structured Questions:

Q: Are the scenario and the implementation choices clearly described?

Yes, but in some cases the functionality requested for implementation is a bit generic and could use some more detail.

Q: Do the scenarios represent a plausible decision scenario?

Yes, most of it.

Q: Could the scenarios arise across different development contexts?

Yes, but likely with a more limited scope regarding the decisions that can be made.

Q: Can the implementation choices in the scenarios be driven by the personal preferences of the developer on fairness, privacy, inclusiveness, transparency & explainability, traceability, and resource consumption?

Yes

Q: Did you feel inclined to provide socially acceptable responses rather than express your genuine preferences?

No, I based the answers on my experience and my own preferences.

Follow-up discussion:

dev_001: In general, I found some questions very specific, while others are described in more generic terms. The problem that I see is that the statement points to the implementation choice that requires the highest effort among the two alternatives. For

example, the scenario with the message error for password, why would I choose to implement the solution that requires the most development effort?

Author: That's the point of the dilemma implied in the questionnaire: there may be ethical reasons that pushes a developer to prefer an implementation option that enhances, in this case, transparency and explainability.

dev_001: I see. So in this case I would answer "very unlikely" to this item. There's also the scenario with the gender option… there I would choose the implementation allowing selecting more options. It remains the problem that most of the times the option with more implementation effort is the one I am asked to agree with. When this happens, I feel like I am more inclined to to answer "unlikely"

Author's note for questionnaire improvement: balance the number of positive and inverse-key statements

dev_001: Another point concerns the fact that, for the password example, since it is a matter that I do not care about, I would not select "very likely" or "very unlikely". I'd rather select one of the more neutral options, since I do not see the high impact of the ethical aspect.

Author's note: scenarios differences in the relevance of ethical implication of the choice can be naturally balanced by the response, which tend to be neutral when the difference in the ethical impact of the choice is less relevant